# Josh Symonds

Hands-on staff engineer: agent platforms, LLM evaluation, and AI infrastructure.

Santa Barbara, CA · josh@joshsymonds.com · 773-480-4810 · joshsymonds.com · github.com/joshsymonds

Built a company-wide agent platform and the production-replay evals that moved its code review to open-weight models at 1/16 the cost, and an eval system that replaced LLM-as-judge with a decider model validated on held-out pairs. Building with coding agents since 2025; 15 years in infrastructure and security.

Builds with: Go, Python, TypeScript · Kubernetes, Terraform, AWS, GCP · GitOps · Claude Code, MCP, model evals

## EXPERIENCE

### Attain — Remote

Director of SRE, Consumer Product — Mar 2026 - Present

- Marvin: Created Marvin, a company-wide agent platform in Slack for code review, incident investigation, and internal workflows: 116 users across engineering, support, and operations.
- Orchestration & Gateway: Designed Go/Kubernetes orchestration for ephemeral agent workers (per-user OAuth, Cedar policies, versioned model routes) and the company's LLM gateway (SSO keys, spend tracking, zero-retention providers).
- Code Review: Shipped multi-stage AI code review with a verifier pass: 2,100+ reviews, 87% positive (300+ ratings).
- Evaluation: Built an evaluation harness that replays production reviews against candidate models, with frozen dev/holdout cases and a version-pinned LLM judge. Blind review found the original verifier wrong on 37% of disputed calls. Moved review to open-weight models: cost per review fell 16× in a month, and median review time halved.
- Incidents: Automated investigation of 2,170+ alerts; its fix merge requests are mergeable as written 95% of the time.

## INDEPENDENT ENGINEERING, BUILT WITH CODING AGENTS

### Savecraft — Go, TypeScript, Rust, WebAssembly, MCP · 2026

- Shipped an AI gaming companion for 14 games, in OpenAI's connector directory: sandboxed WASM save parsers on the player's device, and MCP tools and the chat loop on Cloudflare Workers behind OAuth 2.1.
- Built its eval system before choosing a model: 295 scenarios × 3 runs from production logs. A 13-model bake-off ranked an open-weight model first, ahead of frontier models costing 14× more. Replaced LLM-as-judge with a decider model (Jev) validated on held-out pairs, picking the stronger model in 95% of pairs vs 88% for the old judge ($p = 1.9e-17$).

### Gambit & Tiltyard — Claude Code, Go

- Released Gambit, a Claude Code plugin that takes tasks from spec to release with test-evidence gates; Tiltyard replays real repository tasks to score models and agent harnesses.

### LiveWorld (consulting) — AWS, EKS, Terraform, Flux · 2013 - Present

- Run its AWS/EKS platform and GPU inference for its ML product (Karpenter, KEDA); wrote its SOC 2/GDPR controls.

### Open Source — Dynamoid (original author; 13M+ downloads) · nix-config (nine-host NixOS fleet; 837 stars)

## PREVIOUS ROLES

### CrossnoKaye — Santa Barbara, CA

Principal Infrastructure Engineer / Senior Manager, Core Services — Jan 2021 - Feb 2026

- Platform: Built the control plane and deploy tool (approval-gated, about 5,800 deploys in 2025), the end-to-end test framework, and the CLIs; ran 9 AWS accounts and 10 EKS clusters.
- Edge: Built the industrial IoT edge OS with zero-touch provisioning and over-the-air updates, and led the migration from k3os to Talos Linux as the fleet grew to 123 production deployments.
- Security & AI: Led SOC 2 Type 1 and presented an IIAR paper on industrial cybersecurity. Set the LLM usage policy, ran weekly "Cooking with Claude Code" workshops, and stood up self-hosted LLM inference for internal search.

### Capital Markets Gateway — Chicago, IL

DevOps Engineer & CISO — Oct 2019 - Dec 2020

- Kubernetes operators and multi-region failover on AKS, custom Terraform providers, and NIST CSF and ISO 27001 programs that passed bank audits.

### M1 Finance — Chicago, IL

Chief Information Security Officer — Aug 2015 - Oct 2019

- Employee #8. Built M1's infrastructure from launch to nearly $1B in assets (it has since passed $12B): Chef, then self-run Kubernetes, then EKS. Ran security through SOC 2 and SEC, FINRA, and bank audits.

---

Education — University of Chicago, BA in East Asian Languages and Civilizations